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PRODUCT BLUEPRINT & MARKET RESEARCH

DharmaScroll

A gamified Bhagavad Gita companion for Bharat: scroll shlokas, speak your day, earn Moksh Points

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कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि॥

Bhagavad Gita 2.47

Market research · Product strategy · Gamification economy · Architecture · Wireframes

VERSION 1.0 · NOVEMBER 2026 · PREPARED FOR KARTIKEYA TRIVEDI

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What is inside

Everything needed to take DharmaScroll from idea to the Play Store and App Store: the market, the competitors, the product, the game economy, the system, the screens, and the plan.

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01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Turn doomscrolling into dharma-scrolling

DharmaScroll is a mobile app that replaces the reels habit with a full-screen feed of Bhagavad Gita shlokas, lets a user speak about their day and receive the shloka that fits it, and wraps the whole thing in a points and streak system built to bring people back every day.

1. Shloka Feed

Vertical swipe through all 700 verses in an old-parchment aesthetic. Sanskrit, transliteration, Hindi and English, chanting audio, tap to open word-by-word meaning and the story behind it.

2. Mann Darpan

Tap the mic, speak in Hindi, English or Hinglish about a sad, stressful or joyful moment. The app finds the most fitting shloka and gives a short life lesson with three concrete actions.

3. Moksh Points

Points for reading, reflecting, completing lessons and keeping a Daily Sankalp. Clear, gentle rules that reduce points for gaming or abandoning commitments. Levels, leagues, badges, an 18-day Gita Yatra.

Why now

$58.6B
Indian faith market (2023), growing ~8.8% a year

+60%
MAU growth of India's top 10 religious apps (2025)

~$40M
Hallow's estimated 2025 net revenue from prayer subscriptions

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Scroll-format, gamified Gita apps with real traction found

The Christian market has already proven the "scroll the scripture" format: Scroll the Bible, Sown, BibleTok, HolyReel and a dozen clones launched in 2025 and 2026, and Hallow shows people pay for faith habit products. In India, money has gone to puja and astrology commerce (Sri Mandir, Astrotalk, Vama). Nobody owns daily Gita engagement on the phone, and the existing Gita AI bots have a public trust problem. That is the gap.

Honest verdict

The idea is strong but the scroll feed alone is not a moat. Scroll the Bible clones were built in weeks; a Gita version will be copied just as fast. What can be defended is (a) a **curated, scholar-reviewed emotion-to-shloka index** that makes Mann Darpan answers feel uncannily right, (b) a **Hinglish voice experience** tuned for India, and (c) a **game economy that rewards reflection, not screen time**. Build those three properly and the feed becomes the cheap top of funnel.

Two things will kill it if ignored: AI that speaks "as Krishna" and says something harmful (this already happened to GitaGPT bots in 2023), and point deductions that feel like punishment in a spiritual product. Both are designed around in this document.

02 · MARKET RESEARCH

The faith-tech opportunity

India is the second largest religious-tech funding market in the world, and devotional app usage is growing faster here than anywhere else. But almost all of the money is in transactions, not daily engagement.

$58.56B
Indian faith market size, 2023 (8.82% CAGR), pilgrimage the biggest share

~950
religion-tech startups tracked in India by Tracxn

$50.5M
Indian religious-tech funding in 2024, the peak year

15%
India's share of global religious-tech investment since 2020, #2 after the US

Market sizing for DharmaScroll

Layer	Definition	Estimate	Basis
TAM	Hindu smartphone users in India plus the Hindu diaspora who engage with devotional content online	~400M people	Large majority of India's ~700M+ smartphone users identify as Hindu; diaspora adds high-ARPU tail
SAM	18 to 45 year olds who consume short-form video daily and have shown interest in Gita, spirituality, self-help or mental wellbeing content	~60 to 80M	Overlap of reels-native youth with devotional and motivational content audiences
SOM (3 yr)	Realistic reach for a focused Gita-first app with festival-led marketing	2M MAU, 2 to 3% paying	Sri Mandir reached 3.5M MAU in ~4 years with heavy funding; we target a narrower, cheaper-to-serve niche

Signals from the market

Demand is real and growing

- India's top 10 religious apps grew monthly active users by 60% and downloads by 50% in the period TechCrunch reported (mid 2025), outpacing the global trend.
- Sri Mandir, the leading Hindu devotional app, has over 4 crore downloads and around 3.5M monthly active users, about 90K of them outside India.
- Growth in Indian spiritual tech is driven by 25 to 35 year olds and NRIs who want to stay connected to culture and faith.
- Duolingo proves gamified daily habits can scale: 58.7M daily active users in Q2 2026 and more than 10M learners with a 365-day streak.

Money flows to transactions, not habit

- Sri Mandir earns from puja and chadhava commissions (roughly 20 to 25% of each offering). FY25 revenue was about ₹70 Cr with a ₹45 Cr loss.
- ARPU gap is huge: around ₹7,000 per diaspora user versus ₹600 to 800 in India. Diaspora is worth designing for from day one.
- Astrotalk-style apps earn mostly from per-minute paid consultations.
- Interestingly, YouVersion's Bible app overtook Sri Mandir as India's #1 religious app in 2025. A free, daily-reading product beat a commerce product on usage. That is the slot DharmaScroll targets for Hindus.

Takeaway. The Indian market has a proven devotional audience and investor appetite, but no product that does for the Gita what YouVersion, Hallow and Scroll the Bible do for Christians: a beautiful, daily, habit-forming reading and reflection experience. DharmaScroll should own engagement first and add commerce (pujas, books, courses) only later.

03 · COMPETITOR TEARDOWN

The two reference apps

You named Scroll the Bible and Vessels as the inspiration. Here is what each actually does, how it monetizes, and what DharmaScroll should take from it.

Scroll the Bible (JCBSN LLC, iOS)

Concept. Pitches itself as turning the scrolling habit that drains your day into one that fills it. The core screen is a smooth full-screen vertical feed through every book and chapter of the Bible, one verse at a time, with no clutter.

Features. Main feed; a Discover page of random verses each pre-loaded with a deep study; search, favourites, notes, verse comments, sharing, reading plans, progress tracking and widgets.

AI. Premium "AI Bible Study" features, which its own privacy policy says are sent to OpenAI's API.

Pricing. Free core, Premium at $7.99/month or $39.99/year in the US store.

Traction. Rated 4.8 on the App Store from around 4.9K ratings, which is strong for a 2025 launch by a tiny team.

Lesson. The format works because it borrows an existing motor habit (swipe up) and swaps the content. The emotional pitch is guilt relief: "I scroll anyway, at least now it is good for me."

Vessel: Body · Mind · Spirit (Crown Legacy Ventures, iOS)

Assumption: "Vessels" refers to this Christian wellness app released July 2026. If you meant a different app, the comparison logic below still holds.

Concept. A Christian wellness app about discipline, faith and wholeness: building daily habits, tracking fitness, journaling, and standing firm in moments of temptation.

Signature feature. Accountability: invite a trusted partner who sees your progress and sends encouragement.

Positioning. For people who "take their faith seriously" and want it to show up in body, mind and spirit, not just reading.

Lesson. Vessel shows the second half of what you want: scripture is not just read, it is *applied* to daily life with journaling, habits and a partner who keeps you honest. DharmaScroll's Mann Darpan plus Daily Sankalp is the Gita version of this: share your day, get a shloka, commit to an action, get reminded, reflect.

The wider "scroll the scripture" wave

App	What it adds to the format	Model	Steal this
Sown (Android)	One verse at a time over a painted scene; tap any verse for a plain-language meaning card; no sign-up, no ads; "For You" learns from likes and saves; 26 editions including Hindi and Tamil	Free; Premium unlocks 40 topic feeds, home-screen feed widget, memory practice	Zero-friction first open, painted backgrounds, topic feeds as the paid hook
HolyReel	30 to 90 second story clips with AI visuals and narration, character chats, streaks and XP	Freemium	Story mode for the Mahabharata context behind each chapter
BibleScroll: Screen Time Faith	Blocks your distracting apps each day until you have read the Bible	Subscription	Optional "Pehle Gita, phir Reels" lock using Screen Time / Digital Wellbeing APIs
ChristPath	Reels-style verses plus "Ask" for honest questions about anxiety, hope, forgiveness	Freemium	Validates the feed plus feelings-to-scripture pairing
Bible Scroll (Block Browser)	Mood search that maps what you feel to verse categories; AI chat; animated share cards	Weekly $2.99 / yearly $59.99	Mood entry point, branded share cards for virality

03 · COMPETITOR TEARDOWN

Proof of money, and the Indian field

Hallow: the monetization benchmark

- Catholic prayer and meditation app. Appfigures estimates roughly $40M net revenue in 2025.
- Hallow Plus costs $9.99/month or $69.99/year; daily prayers and a 9-day intro challenge stay free.
- Its Lent "Pray40" challenge pulled 1.4M participants in 2025. In the first 22 days of February 2026 it got 1.2M downloads versus a typical ~280K a month.

Lesson: a time-boxed, calendar-anchored challenge is the single biggest growth lever in faith apps. Our equivalent: the **18-day Gita Yatra**, one chapter a day like the 18 days of Kurukshetra, launched around Gita Jayanti, Navratri and New Year.

Gita AI bots: the cautionary tale

- GitaGPT was launched in early 2023 by a Bengaluru engineer; at least five GitaGPT clones appeared between January and March 2023, some answering ~50K questions a day.
- Rest of World found three of these bots said killing is acceptable if it is one's dharma, and some voiced opinions on the Prime Minister, with weak filters on caste and gender questions.
- Survivors such as gitagpt.in sell freemium plans from about ₹199/month.

Lesson: never let the AI speak in the first person as Krishna, never free-generate scripture, always retrieve from a vetted verse index, and filter violence, caste, politics and medical topics before and after generation.

Indian devotional landscape

App	Core job	Revenue model	Gap vs DharmaScroll
Sri Mandir AppsForBharat, $61M raised	Remote pujas and chadhava at 100+ temples, prasad delivery, bhajans, panchang, daily darshan	20 to 25% commission on offerings; ~$12M run rate at start of 2025; ~55% six-month retention	Ritual commerce, not scripture learning or reflection
Vama, Utsav, DevDham	Virtual puja, astrology, prasad, temple community	Per-puja booking, consultations	Same transactional lane
Astrotalk	Live paid astrology consultations	~90% from per-minute calls	Prediction, not wisdom; different trust model
Gita reader apps ISKCON, Holy Gita, etc.	Book-style reading with translation and commentary, sometimes audio	Free, ads, donations	Static, no habit loop, dated UI, no personalisation
GitaGPT and clones	Chat with "Krishna" about problems	Freemium, ~₹199/month	Text chat only, trust issues, no feed, no game, no progress

Feature matrix

Capability	Scroll the Bible	Vessel	Hallow	Sri Mandir	GitaGPT	DharmaScroll
Full-screen swipe feed	✓	–	–	–	–	✓
Hindu scripture, Sanskrit + Hindi	–	–	–	partial	✓	✓
Voice: speak feelings, get scripture	–	–	–	–	text only	✓
Action plan and follow-up	–	✓	partial	–	–	✓
Points, levels, leagues	progress	habits	streaks	–	–	✓
Structured course (18 chapters)	plans	–	✓	–	–	✓
Community / accountability	comments	✓	✓	–	–	✓

04 · INTERFACE AND INTERACTION ANALYSIS

What the reference apps get right

Breaking down the interface choices of Scroll the Bible, Sown and Vessel into principles, then into specific DharmaScroll decisions.

Pattern seen	Why it works	DharmaScroll decision
One unit per screen Scroll the Bible, Sown	Each verse is a complete, finishable item. Same dopamine shape as a reel; no wall of text.	One shloka per card. Long shlokas get a "continue" fold. Never show two verses on one card.
Swipe up, nothing else	Zero learning curve; muscle memory transfers from Instagram and YouTube Shorts.	Swipe up = next, double tap = save (with a lotus burst), long press = share, tap = expand.
Painted / atmospheric backgrounds Sown	Makes each card feel like art, not a text file. Drives screenshots and sharing.	Aged parchment base with rotating Pattachitra, Madhubani and miniature-style illustrated scenes from the Mahabharata.
Tap for meaning Sown, Scroll the Bible	Respects the casual scroller and the serious reader in the same screen.	Bottom sheet with three tabs: Shabdarth (word-by-word), Katha (who said it to whom and why), Jeevan (modern lesson).
No sign-up to start Sown	The first verse is visible within seconds; account creation is deferred to the moment of value.	Guest mode by default. Ask for phone OTP only when the user saves, earns their first badge, or uses Mann Darpan.
Discover / random with depth	Removes "where do I start" paralysis.	For You feed blends: sequential chapter reading, mood-matched verses, and popular shlokas.
Accountability partner Vessel	Social commitment is a stronger motivator than self-tracking.	"Sakha" (friend) pairing: share streaks with one friend or family member, send a nudge, do the Yatra together.
Habit + journal + temptation Vessel	Moves faith from reading to living.	Mann Darpan journal plus Daily Sankalp (a small, concrete promise from the lesson) with evening check-in.
Widgets and home screen	Re-entry without opening the app; free daily impression.	Shloka of the Day widget and lock-screen widget, with streak flame.

Where they are weak (our opening)

Shallow engagement

Scroll apps measure swipes. A feed with no checkpoints becomes another mindless scroll, the exact thing users wanted to escape. We add checkpoints, reflection and a daily cap on point-earning swipes.

No personal relevance

Verses arrive randomly. Mann Darpan makes the scripture answer *your* day, which is the moment people remember and tell friends about.

Thin gamification

Mostly a streak counter. We bring a full but humane economy: points, levels named after spiritual stages, leagues, badges and seasonal Yatras.

05 · POSITIONING, PERSONAS AND THE GAP

Who it is for

Positioning statement

For young Indians and the diaspora who feel stuck in endless scrolling and want calm and direction, **DharmaScroll** is the Gita companion that turns your daily scroll into wisdom and turns your daily troubles into a shloka and a plan. Unlike puja apps or Gita chatbots, it builds a daily habit you can feel and track, grounded only in verified verses.

Riya, 22 · Pune

Engineering student, 4+ hrs/day on Instagram

Pain: anxiety about placements, guilt about screen time, comparison with peers.

Wants: something calming that still feels modern; would never open a "religious" app with a dated UI.

Hooks: feed aesthetic, streaks, share cards, Mann Darpan in Hinglish at 1 am.

Amit, 34 · Lucknow

Bank manager, married, one child

Pain: work stress, anger, little time; read the Gita once as a kid, wants to finally finish it.

Wants: 10 minutes a day, in Hindi, with progress he can see.

Hooks: 18-day Gita Yatra, morning audio, Daily Sankalp, family league with his parents.

Priya, 29 · New Jersey

Second-gen NRI, product designer

Pain: feels disconnected from roots, cannot read Devanagari, wants to teach her future kids.

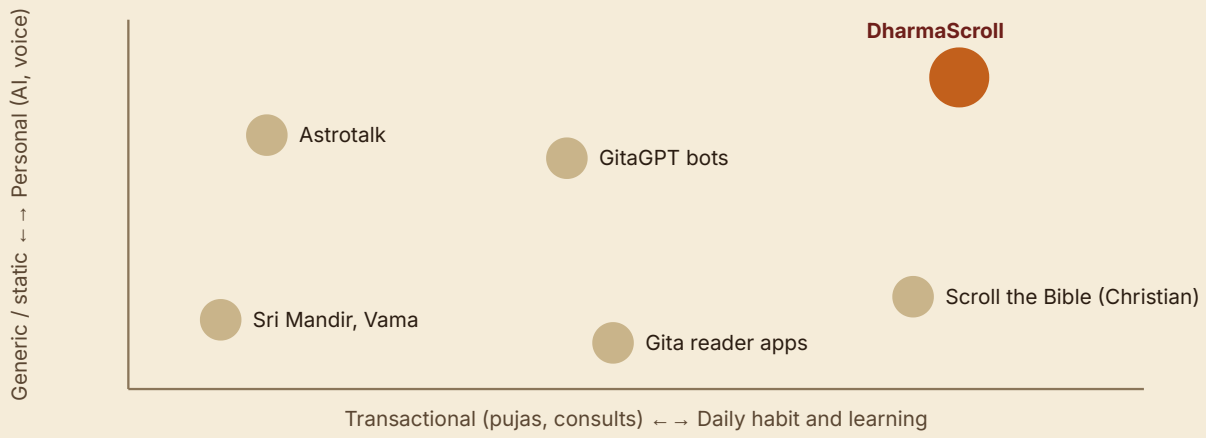
Wants: English-first, beautiful, explains context, not preachy.

Hooks: transliteration and audio, story context, premium pays easily in USD.

Jobs to be done

When I...	I want to...	So I can...
reach for my phone out of boredom	scroll something that does not make me feel worse	end the day calmer and guilt-free
have a bad day at work or a fight at home	say it out loud and get perspective right away	respond with clarity instead of reacting
feel a moment of joy or success	mark it and stay grounded	not get carried away (samatvam)
think "I should really read the Gita"	follow a short, structured path	actually finish all 18 chapters
want my family to share the habit	do it together and nudge each other	build a shared ritual

Competitive positioning map



06 · PRODUCT DEFINITION

Five tabs, one daily ritual

The app is deliberately simple: five bottom tabs, with the mic in the centre because sharing your day is the signature act.



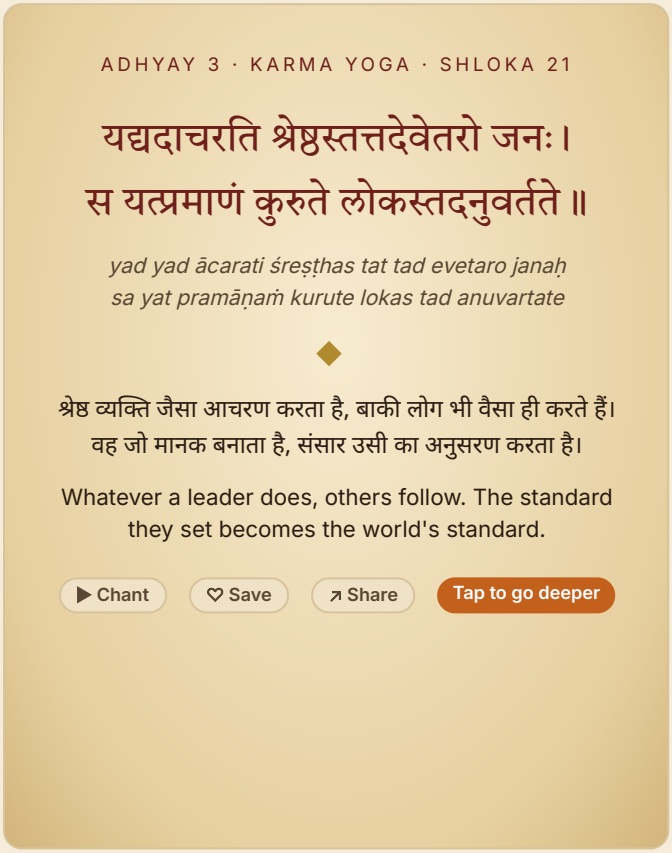
Feature specification (MVP scope marked)

Feature	What it does	Phase
Shloka Feed	Full-screen vertical feed. Each card: Devanagari shloka, IAST transliteration, Hindi and English meaning, chant audio (tap to play), illustrated background. Actions: save, share, listen, expand. Modes: *Kram* (sequential, resumes where you left), *For You* (mood + history), *Topics* (anger, fear, duty, love, focus, grief, success).	MVP
Expand sheet	Shabdarth (word-by-word meaning and anvaya), Katha (speaker, listener, scene in the war), Jeevan (one modern application, 60 to 90 words), plus "Ask about this verse" (text, Pro).	MVP
Checkpoint cards	After every 7 cards, one quiz or reflection card inserted in the feed ("Which word means 'action'?" or "Where did you see attachment today?"). This is what turns a scroll into learning, and what earns most feed points.	MVP
Mann Darpan	Hold the mic and speak (up to 2 min) about a sad, stressful, confusing or happy moment. Output: one primary shloka, why it fits, a short life lesson, three concrete actions, and an optional Daily Sankalp. Saved privately to journal.	MVP
Daily Sankalp	A small daily commitment ("Read 5 shlokas", "Do the work without checking results for 1 hour", "Speak calmly to Papa"). Evening check-in: done / partly / not today. Drives both points and the follow-up loop.	MVP
Gita Yatra	Duolingo-style path of 18 chapters, each split into 4 to 8 lessons of 5 shlokas, with a short quiz and a chapter summary. Unlock as you go. Seasonal 18-day challenges.	MVP (Ch 1 to 3)
Moksh Points	Full points economy with earning, deductions, levels, streaks and Vishram (rest) days. Detailed in section 08.	MVP
Sangha	Weekly leagues of 30 people at similar levels; family and friend groups; Sakha accountability partner; nudges.	V1.1
Library	Book-mode reader for all 18 chapters with search by word, verse number, topic, character. Later: Ramayana, Upanishads, Vidura Niti, Chanakya Niti.	MVP Gita only
Share cards	Auto-designed 9:16 card with shloka, meaning and app watermark for Instagram Story and WhatsApp Status. Main viral loop.	MVP
Widgets & notifications	Shloka of the Day widget, streak reminder, Sankalp check-in, festival notes.	MVP
Focus lock	Optional: block chosen apps each morning until today's 5 shlokas are done (Android first via Accessibility / Digital Wellbeing, iOS via Screen Time API).	V1.2
Audio Satsang	Guided 5 to 10 min audio: chant + meaning + reflection, for commute and sleep. Main Pro content.	V1.1

06 · PRODUCT DEFINITION

Anatomy of a shloka card

The card is the atomic unit of the whole product. This is the reference you shared (Gita 3.21), restructured into the DharmaScroll card format.



Layer 1: the card (always visible)

- Chapter, yoga name and verse ID as a quiet header
- Sanskrit in Tiro Devanagari, the largest element
- IAST transliteration in italic (toggle off in settings)
- One-line meaning in the user's language (Hindi / English / both)
- Right rail: chant, save, share, MP earned indicator

Layer 2: the expand sheet

- **Shabdarth:** yat yat = whatever; ācarati = does; śreṣṭhaḥ = the best person; itaraḥ janaḥ = common people...
- **Katha:** Krishna to Arjuna, before the war. Arjuna wants to withdraw; Krishna reminds him that people watch what leaders do, citing King Janaka (3.20).
- **Jeevan:** "Your younger cousin copies how you treat your phone, your parents, your work. Pick one habit today you would be proud to see copied."

Layer 3: action

- "Make this my Sankalp" button turns the Jeevan line into today's commitment
- "Ask about this verse" (Pro) opens a grounded Q&A on just this shloka

Content per verse (the content database)

Field	Example / spec	Source
sanskrit, iast	Original text and transliteration	Public domain
meaning_hi, meaning_en	Short (≤ 30 words) and full meaning	Own translation, scholar-reviewed
word_meanings[]	Word, root, meaning	Own, from open grammar datasets
speaker, listener, context	Krishna → Arjuna; scene summary 40 to 60 words	Own writing
life_lesson_hi/en	60 to 90 word modern application	Own writing, reviewed
emotion_tags[], situation_tags[]	anger, fear, grief, pride, confusion, exam, breakup, job loss, success...	Curated by team + scholar (core IP)
audio_chant_url, audio_meaning_url	Studio recording, 2 voices	Commissioned
illustration_id, difficulty	Background art; 1 to 3 for path ordering	Commissioned art

07 · MANN DARPAN (MIRROR OF THE MIND)

Speak your day, receive your shloka

The signature feature. A user holds the mic and talks about whatever is on their mind. Within about 4 seconds they see and hear the shloka that fits, why it fits, and what to do next.

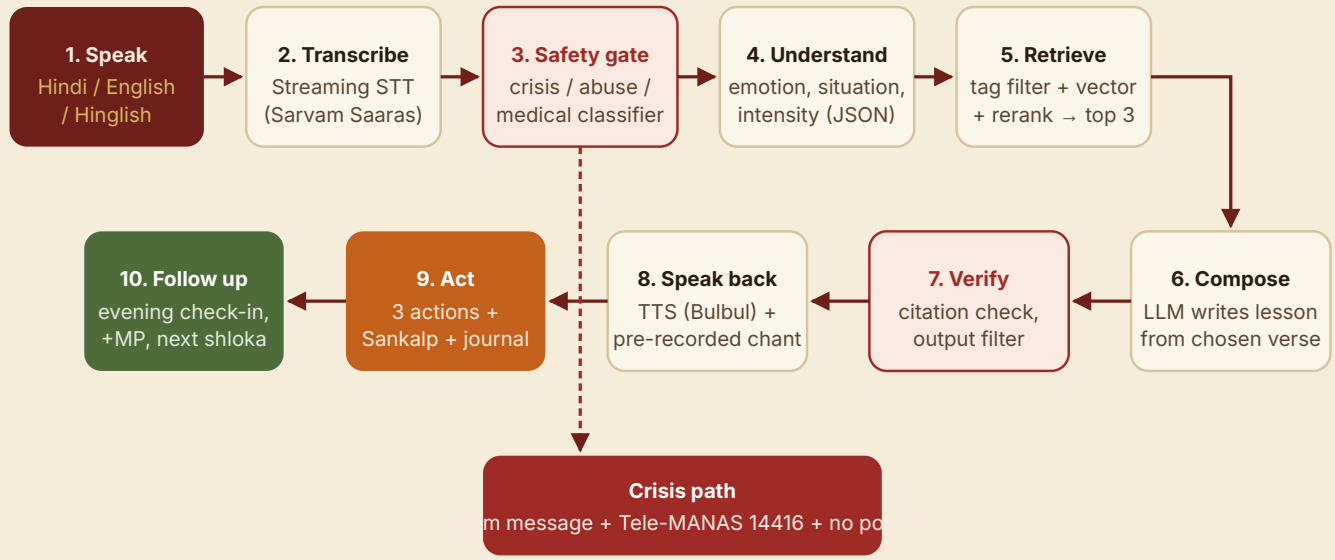


Figure 1. Mann Darpan pipeline. Target end-to-end latency: first text under 2.5 s, voice under 4 s.

Why retrieval before generation

The LLM never picks a verse from memory. Step 4 turns the user's words into structured tags. Step 5 filters our hand-tagged index of 700 verses by those tags, runs vector similarity on the user's summary against each verse's "situations" text, and reranks. The LLM then only explains a verse we hand it. This is what prevents misquotes and the violent or political answers that sank the 2023 Gita bots.

Output contract (what the user gets)

- **Shloka card** with chant audio
- **Why this shloka:** 2 sentences linking their words to the verse
- **Jeevan Path:** 3 small actions for the next 24 hours
- **Sankalp:** one-tap commitment with reminder
- "Show another shloka" (the #2 retrieval result)

Voice and persona rules

- The guide is **"Sakhi / Sakha"**, a calm companion who explains the Gita. It never speaks as Krishna and never says "I am God".
- Mirrors the user's language: Hinglish in, Hinglish out.
- Joy entries get a celebration plus a grounding verse on samatvam (e.g. 2.48), not a lecture.
- No medical, legal or financial advice. No opinions on politics, caste or other religions.

Privacy

- Audio deleted after transcription; transcript encrypted and visible only to the user.
- Never used for ads. Optional "help improve" opt-in for anonymised training.
- "Delete everything" in one tap.

08 · GAMIFICATION ECONOMY

Moksh Points: earn by living it

One currency, simple rules. Points reward depth (reflection, lessons, commitments kept) far more than volume (swipes). Deductions exist, but they target gaming and broken commitments, never bad days or sad feelings.

How you earn

Action	MP	Cap / day
Read a shloka (card visible ≥ 6 s, or audio played)	+2	20 (40 MP)
Open expand sheet and read Katha or Jeevan	+3	10 times
Answer a checkpoint card correctly	+5	no cap
Complete a Yatra lesson	+20	no cap
Perfect lesson quiz (no mistakes)	+10	bonus
Finish a full chapter	+100	bonus
Mann Darpan entry (≥ 15 s, any mood)	+15	2 per day
Evening Sankalp check-in: done	+25	1
Sankalp check-in: partly done (honesty)	+10	1
Write a reflection note on a saved shloka	+8	3
Daily goal met (Nitya Path)	+15	1
Streak milestones 7 / 30 / 108 / 365 days	+50 / 150 / 500 / 1008	once each
Invite a friend who completes day 1	+50	10 total
Nudge Sakha who then completes the day	+5	1

How points decrease

Rule	MP
Speed-scroll: 5+ cards in a row under 2 s each pauses feed points for 10 min, and shows a gentle "slow down" card	earn 0
Broken Sankalp: committed in the morning, no check-in by midnight (silent skip)	−10
Abandoned Yatra challenge (opted in, then missed 2 days in a row)	−30
Inactivity decay: after 3 days with no activity, lose 2% of the current level's progress per day (never below the level floor)	−2%/day
Quiz guessing: 3 wrong answers in under 3 s each	−5
Abuse: spam entries, gibberish recordings, reported share-card misuse (after review)	−50 to reset
Streak break (no Vishram day available)	streak to 0, MP kept

Protective rules (non-negotiable)

- **Never** deduct for mood, sadness, or what a user shares. Sharing pain earns the same as sharing joy.
- **Never** reward length or intensity of misery, so nobody fakes suffering for points.
- Honest "not today" check-in costs **0**, so honesty always beats silence.
- Points never drop below the floor of your current level. You can lose progress, never your title.
- Crisis-flagged sessions are excluded from all game logic.

Vishram days (streak protection). Everyone gets 2 free rest days a month, auto-applied. Earn 1 more for every 7-day streak (max 5 banked). Pro users get unlimited "Tapasya Shield" for illness or travel. Duolingo found separating the streak from the daily goal raised day-14 retention by 3.3%, so the streak only needs one meaningful action (1 lesson, 1 Mann Darpan, or 5 shlokas), not the full daily goal.

08 · GAMIFICATION ECONOMY

Levels, leagues and badges

Seven levels named after the seeker's journey



Level	Meaning	MP needed	Approx. time at 60 MP/day	Unlock
1 Jigyasu	The curious one	0	Day 1	Feed, Mann Darpan, Yatra Ch 1
2 Shravak	The listener	300	~5 days	Profile frame, Sangha leagues
3 Sadhak	The practitioner	1,200	~3 weeks	Custom card themes
4 Karma Yogi	One who acts without attachment	3,500	~2 months	Sangha group creation
5 Bhakta	The devoted	8,000	~4.5 months	Exclusive illustrated deck
6 Gyani	The knower	16,000	~9 months	Mentor badge, answer community questions
7 Sthitaprajna	Steady in wisdom (Gita 2.55)	30,000	~16 months	Physical certificate + Gita book

Sangha leagues (weekly)

Groups of 30 at similar activity, reset every Monday. Five tiers: **Kamal (Lotus) → Tulsi → Peepal → Vat (Banyan) → Kalpavriksha**. Top 7 move up, bottom 5 move down, the rest stay. League score counts *only* depth points (lessons, checkpoints, Sankalp, Mann Darpan), not raw reading, so the leaderboard cannot be won by mindless swiping.

Family and friends

Private Sangha of up to 12 (family WhatsApp group style). Shared weekly goal, shared streak flame when everyone completes the day. This is the Vessel accountability idea, made Indian and multi-generational.

Badges (sample)

Badge	Earned by
Pratham Kadam	First shloka read
Arjuna's Question	First Mann Darpan entry
Brahma Muhurta	5 sessions before 6 am
Karma Yogi	7 Sankalps kept in a row
Kurukshetra 18	Finished the 18-day Yatra
108 Mala	108-day streak
Sampoorna Gita	All 700 shlokas read
Sakha Bandhan	Completed a Yatra with a friend

What points can buy. Keep it non-monetary to avoid feeling transactional: card themes and illustrated decks, Vishram days, profile frames, early access to new scriptures, and at Sthitaprajna a physical certificate. Later, a "Seva" option to convert points into a donated Gita copy for a school or library (funded by the company, capped), which ties progress to real-world good.

09 · ENGAGEMENT AND HABIT DESIGN

Three loops that bring users back

Daily loop

Trigger · widget, 7 am push at chosen time

↓

Action · 5 shlokas + 1 checkpoint

↓

Reward · MP, flame grows, lotus burst

↓

Invest · set tomorrow's Sankalp

↻ repeats next day

Emotional loop

Feeling · a bad day or a good one

↓

Action · speak it in Mann Darpan

↓

Reward · "it knew": the right shloka

↓

Invest · Sankalp + evening follow-up

↻ repeats next day

Social loop

Trigger · friend's share card on Story

↓

Action · install, join their Sangha

↓

Reward · league rank, Sakha streak

↓

Invest · nudge and share back

↻ repeats next day

Figure 2. Trigger, action, reward, investment, applied three ways.

First 7 days: the make-or-break week

Duolingo's retention team found that reaching a 7-day streak is where loss aversion kicks in and retention jumps. So the first week is choreographed:

Day	Experience	Goal
0	Guest opens, first card in < 3 s. After 5 cards: "You just earned your first 10 MP. Save them?" → OTP	Activation, account
1	Push at chosen time. First Mann Darpan prompt: "How was today? Bolo, sun rahe hain."	Aha moment
2	Evening Sankalp check-in, Yatra Ch 1 lesson 1	Second habit
3	Shareable card from their saved verse; Sakha invite	Viral seed
4 to 6	Streak flame grows; Vishram explained; Shravak level teased	Investment
7	7-day badge + 50 MP + "Your week in shlokas" recap card	Lock-in

Notification strategy

Morning (user-set)

"Aaj ka shloka: on doing your work without worrying about results. 30 seconds."

Evening

"Did you keep today's Sankalp? Check in to keep your 12-day flame."

Festival / event

"Gita Jayanti is near. The 18-day Yatra starts now, 4,210 seekers joined."

Anti-addiction guardrails

The product exists to reduce mindless scrolling, so it must never become one. Point-earning reading is capped at 20 shlokas a day; after the Nitya Path is complete the app says "you're done for today" and suggests closing; speed-scrolling pauses points; leagues count only depth actions; and average session time is tracked as a guardrail, not a goal to maximise.

Hard cap: 2 pushes per day, never between 10 pm and 7 am, auto-reduce for users who ignore 5 in a row.

10 · VISUAL IDENTITY

Old parchment, quiet gold, saffron accents

You asked for an old, spiritual feel like the Gita page you shared. The system below keeps that warmth while staying modern enough for a 22-year-old to screenshot without embarrassment.

Colour palette

Patra #F5ECD9
base parchment

Bhoj #EAD8B3
aged edge

Card #FBF6EA
surfaces

Kesar #C2601C
primary action

Sindoor #6E1F1A
headings, Sanskrit

Swarna #B08A2E
rewards, MP

Masi #2A1C11
body text

Ratri #1F0F0A
night mode

Typography

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते

Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit · shlokas · 24 to 28 pt on device

Karma Yoga · Adhyay 3

EB Garamond · headings, translations · 18 to 22 pt

Your Sankalp for today

Inter · UI, labels, numbers · 13 to 16 pt

आज का संकल्प

Noto Sans Devanagari · Hindi UI text

Texture and imagery

- Subtle paper grain and deckled edge vignette on feed cards (as in your reference image)
- Illustration styles: Pattachitra (Odisha), Madhubani, Pahari miniature. Commission a single artist per style for consistency
- Motifs: lotus, conch, chariot wheel, diya, peacock feather as icons and reward bursts
- No photos of deities in UI chrome; art lives on cards, chrome stays quiet

Motion and sound

- Card transition: slow 280 ms ease, slight parallax of background art
- Save: golden lotus bloom; MP earned: small coin glint at rail, never full-screen interruptions
- Optional ambient: tanpura drone, temple bell on streak completion (off by default in public)
- Haptics: soft tick on checkpoint correct, double tick on level up

Night mode "Ratri"

Deep maroon-brown background with diya-gold text, used automatically after sunset for bedtime reading.

Accessibility

- Body contrast ≥ 7:1 on parchment (Masi on Patra)
- Text size slider up to 200%; Sanskrit never below 20 pt
- Every shloka has audio, so non-readers and elders can use it fully
- UI languages at launch: Hindi, English; then Marathi, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Gujarati, Kannada, Odia

Voice of the brand

Warm elder sibling, not a priest. Short sentences, Hinglish where natural, never preachy, never fear-based ("do this or bad karma").

11 · INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Sitemap and end-to-end flow

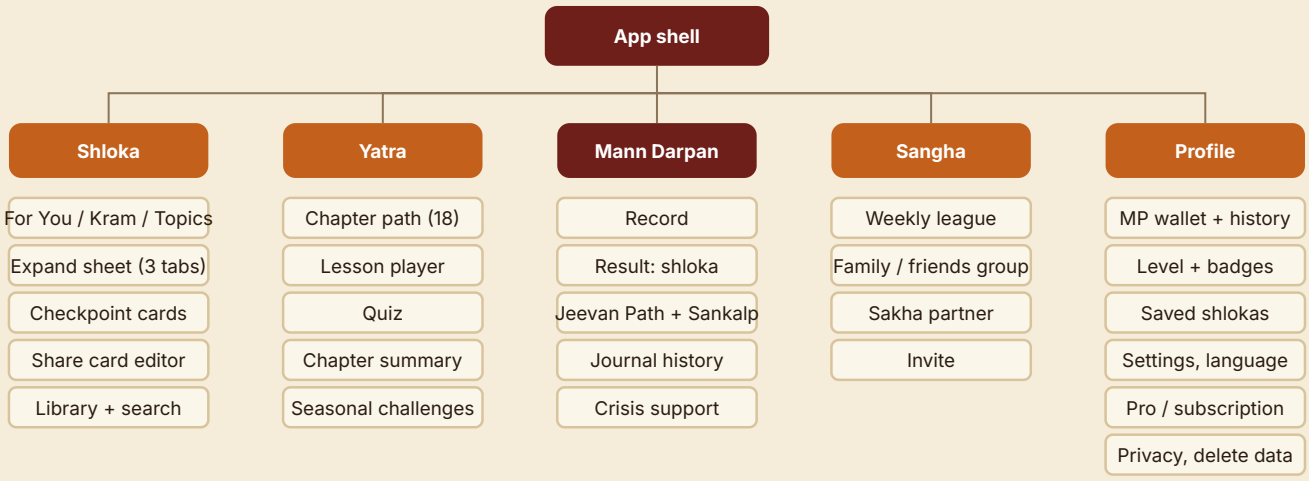


Figure 3. Sitemap. Library is reached from the feed's top bar and from Yatra.

End-to-end user journey

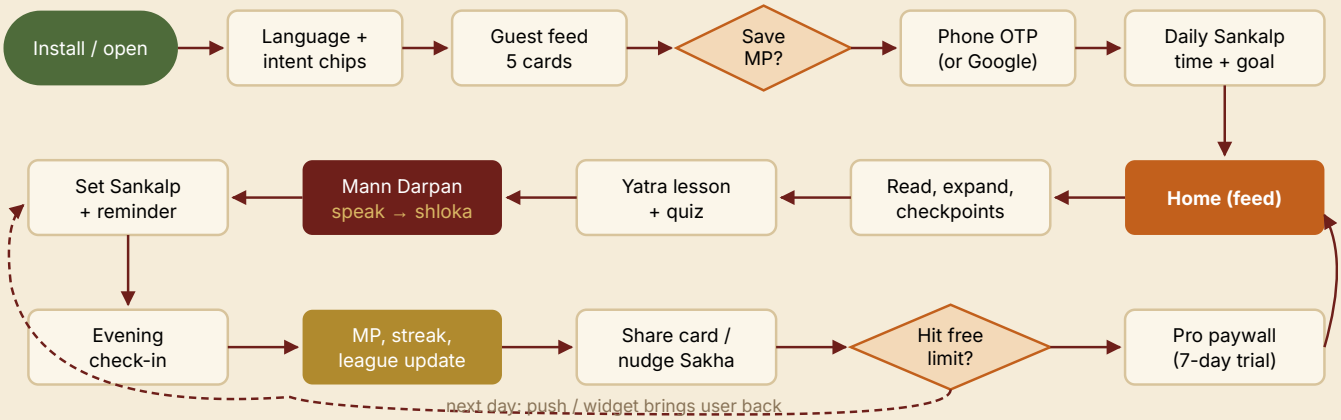
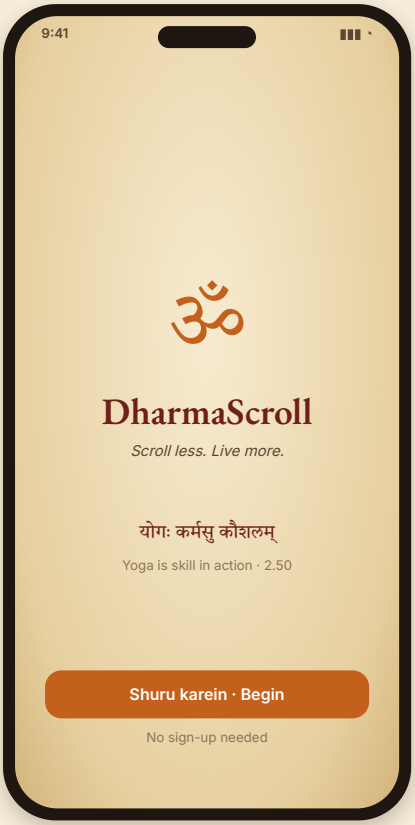


Figure 4. Activation to daily habit to monetization.

12 · WIREFRAMES · A. ONBOARDING

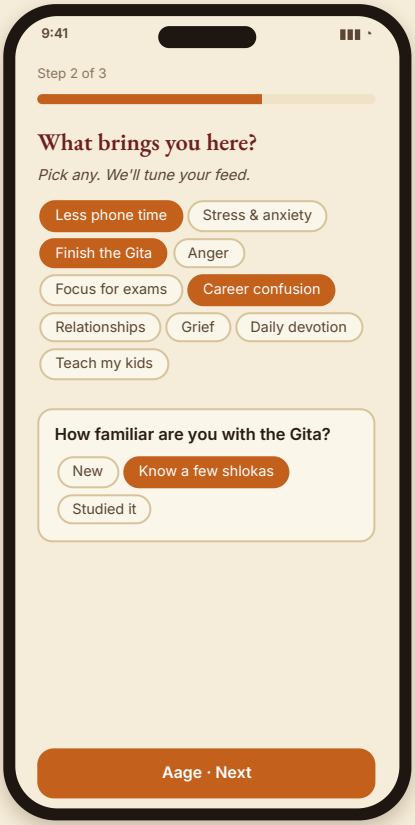
First open to first shloka in under 30 seconds



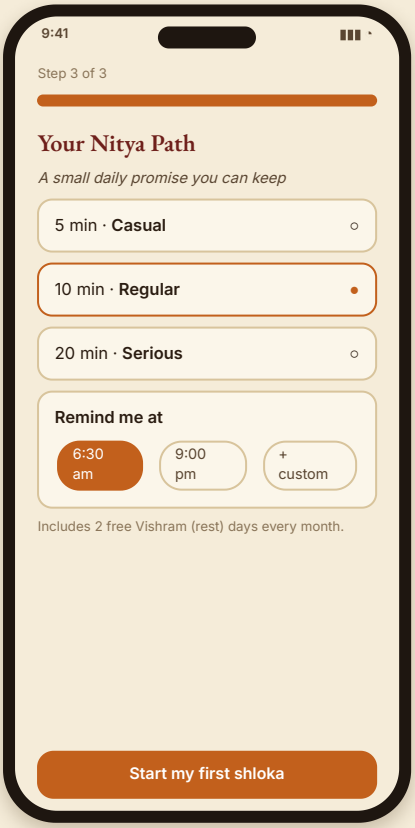
1. Splash
Parchment, Om, one line of Gita. Single CTA, guest by default.



2. Language
Script and translation set once, editable in Settings.



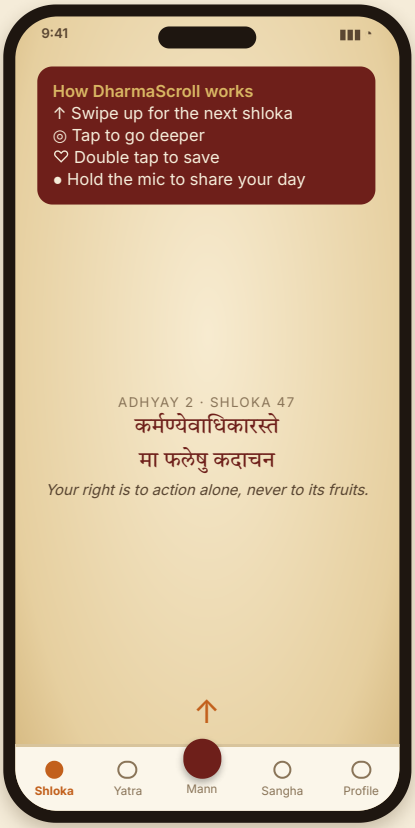
3. Intent
Seeds For You feed and Mann Darpan context; sets path difficulty.



4. Daily goal and reminder
Commitment asked before value, framed as a sankalp.



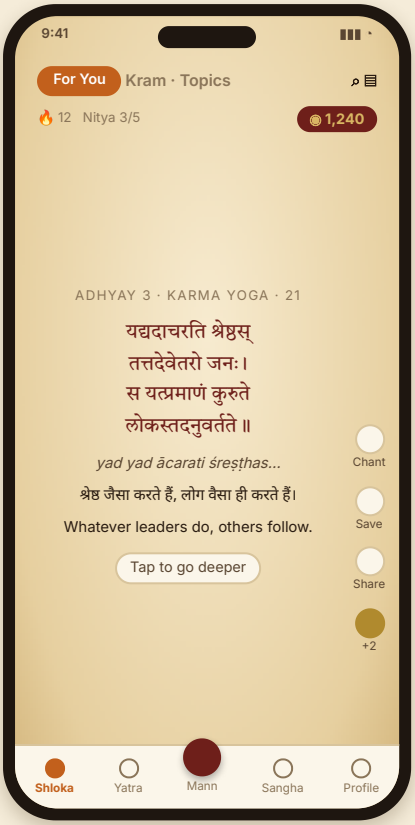
5. Deferred sign-up
Triggered after 5 cards or first save, with points already earned at stake.



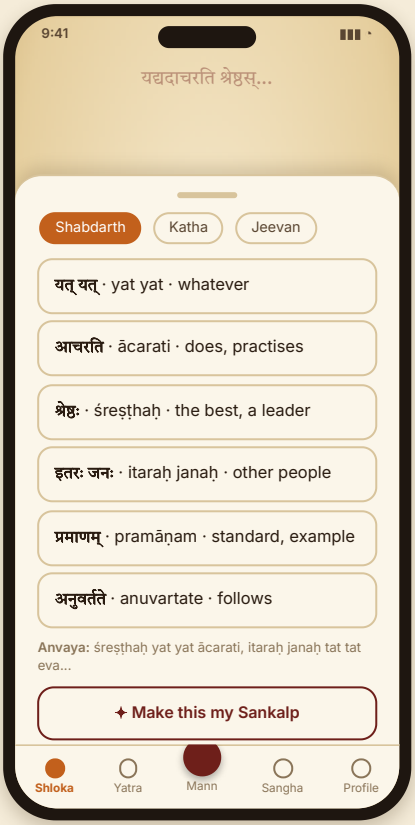
6. Coach marks
Four gestures, overlaid on the very first real card. Dismiss on first swipe.

12 · WIREFRAMES · B. SHLOKA FEED AND DAILY LOOP

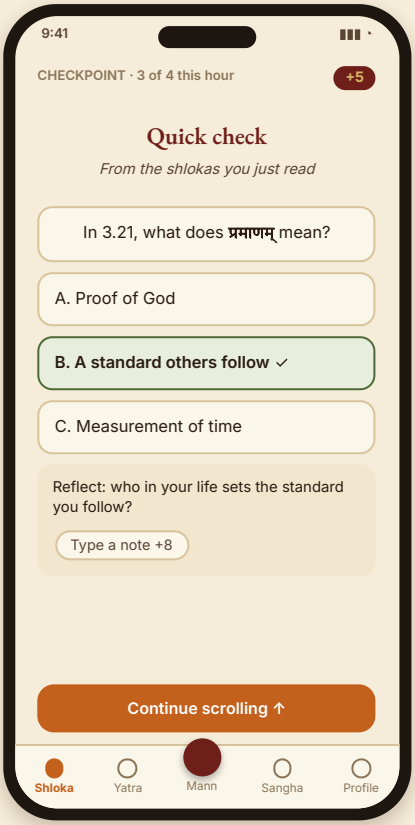
The scroll that teaches



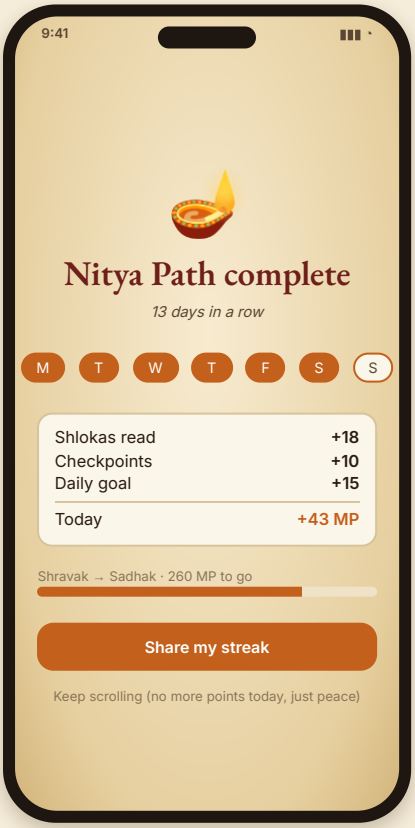
7. Shloka card (home)
One verse, full screen. Streak, daily progress and MP in a slim header.



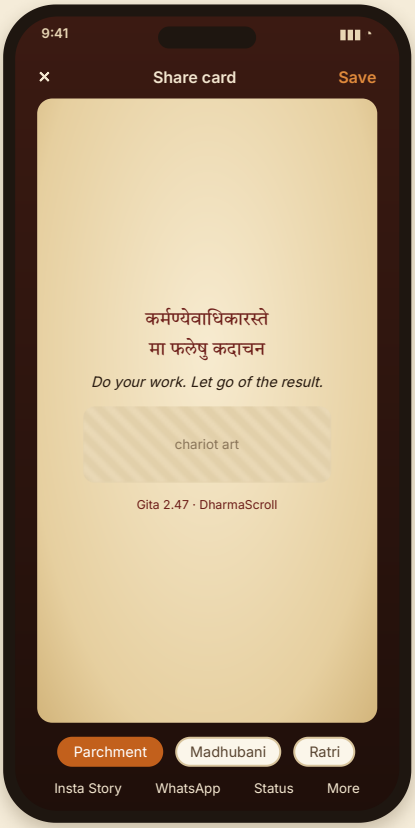
8. Expand sheet
Three tabs: word meaning, story context, modern life lesson. +3 MP on read.



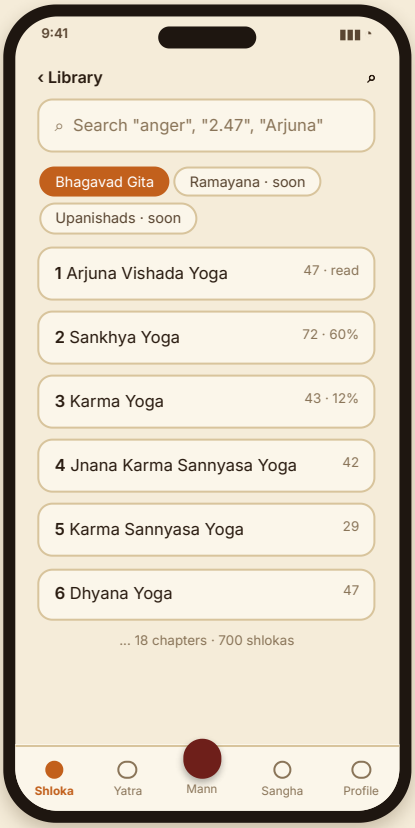
9. Checkpoint card
Inserted every 7 cards. Converts scrolling into recall and reflection.



10. Daily goal reward
Itemised MP so rules feel fair; level progress; share prompt.



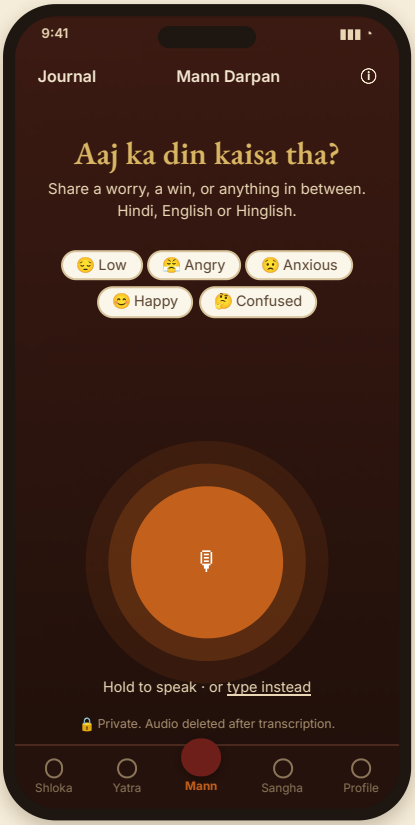
11. Share card editor
9:16 designed card with watermark and deep link. Main viral loop.



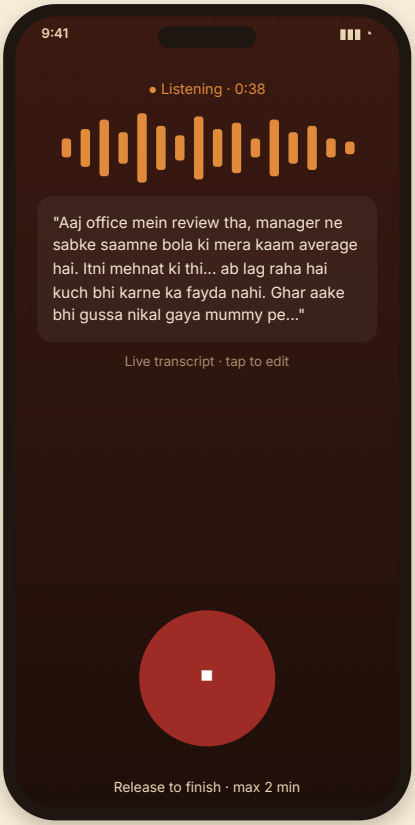
12. Library
Book mode for serious readers, with search and per-chapter progress.

12 · WIREFRAMES · C. MANN DARPAN

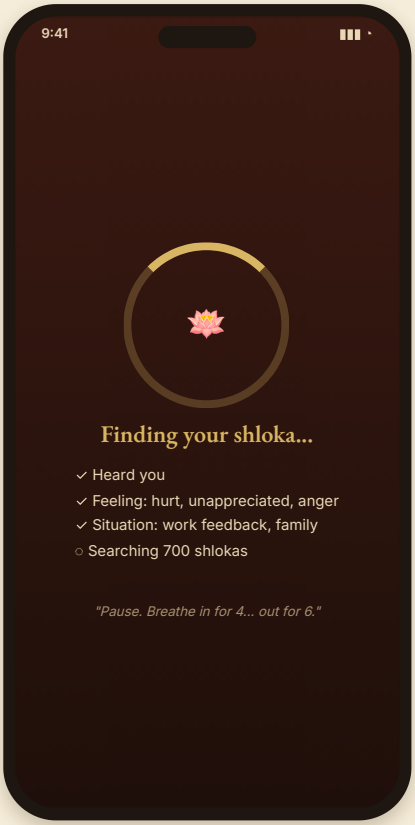
From a hard day to a clear next step



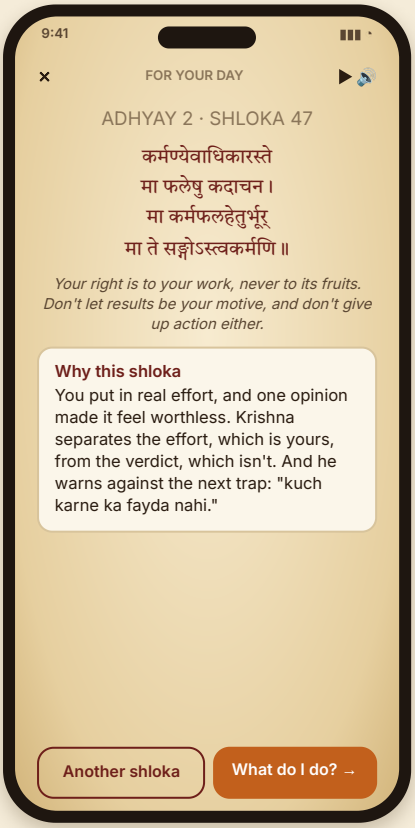
13. Mann Darpan home
Dark, calm, intimate. Optional mood chip, big mic, typing fallback.



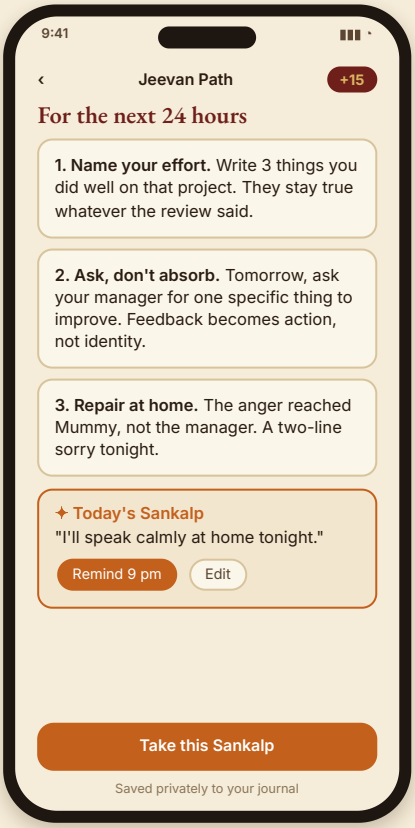
14. Recording
Live waveform and streaming Hinglish transcript the user can correct.



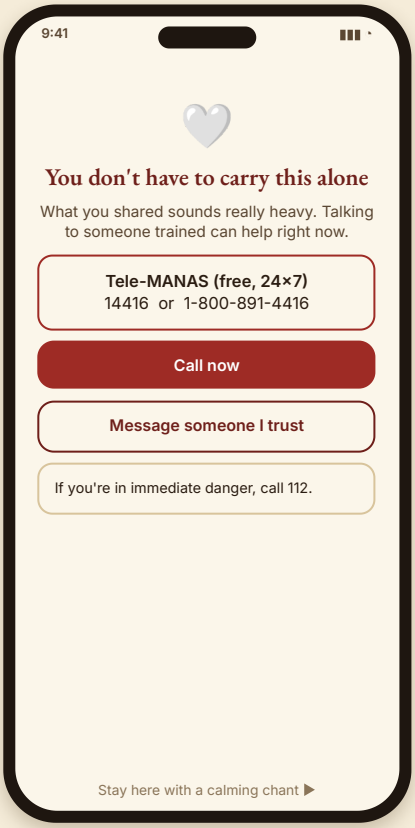
15. Processing
Shows what was understood (builds trust) with a breathing cue to cover 2 to 4 s of latency.



16. Your shloka
Verse with chant audio, plus a 2-line bridge from their exact words to the teaching.



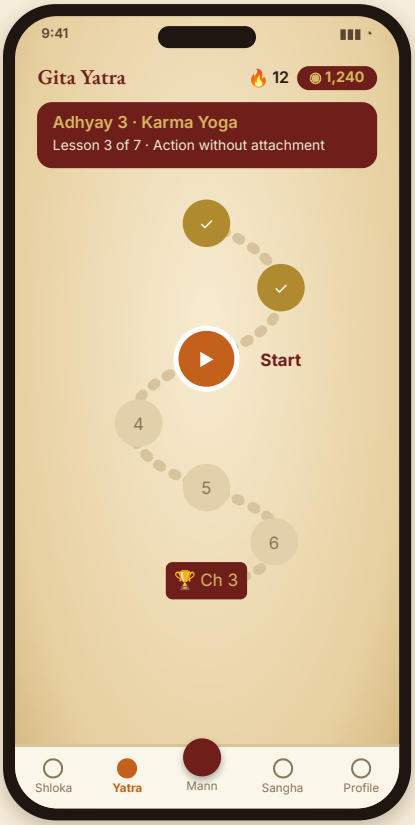
17. Jeevan Path and Sankalp
Three concrete actions from the shloka, one-tap commitment with reminder.



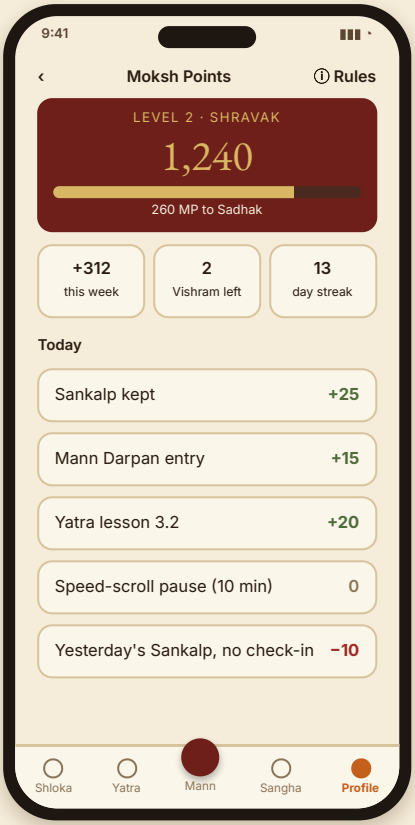
18. Crisis support
Bypasses AI lesson and game logic entirely. Human help first, always.

12 · WIREFRAMES · D. YATRA, MOKSH POINTS, SANGHA, PRO

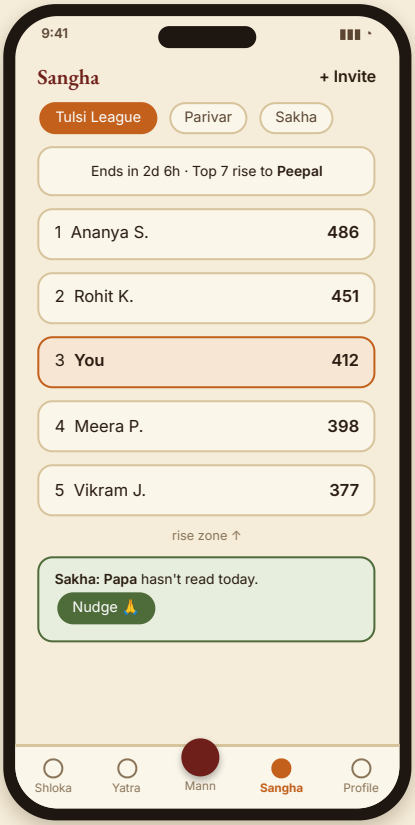
Progress you can see



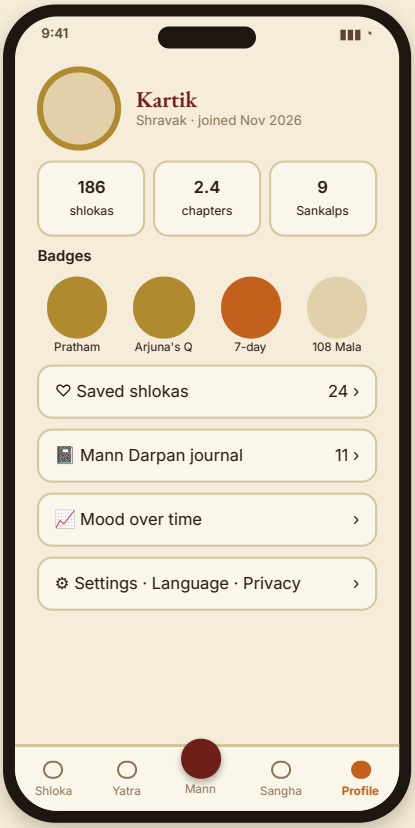
19. Gita Yatra path
18 chapters as a winding path. Each node is a 3-minute lesson + quiz.



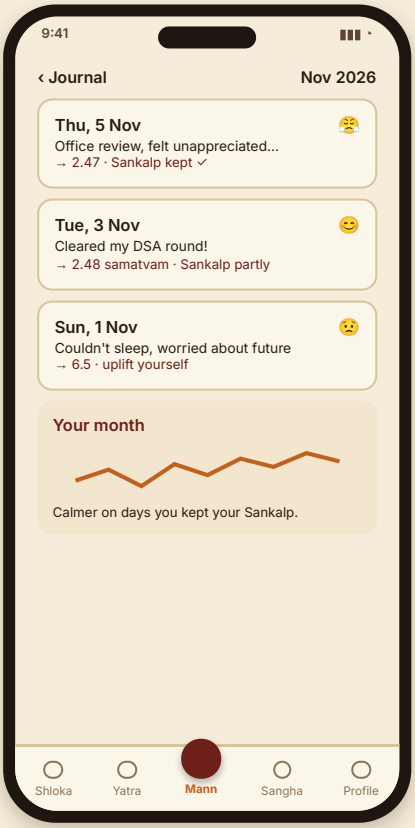
20. MP wallet
Transparent ledger of every gain and loss, with a link to the full rules.



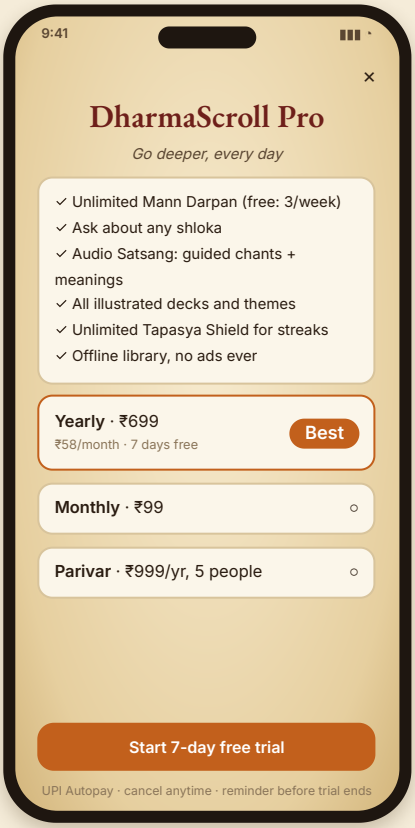
21. Sangha leagues
Weekly league scored on depth points only; family group and Sakha nudges.



22. Profile
Identity, stats, badges, saved verses, private journal and mood trend.



23. Mann Darpan journal
Private history of entries, matched shlokas and Sankalp outcomes.



24. Pro paywall
Shown when free Mann Darpan limit is hit or on Pro features. Never blocks the feed.

13 · SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

How the system fits together

A deliberately boring, cheap-to-run stack: one mobile codebase, a managed Postgres, a small Python service for AI, and a CDN for all static content. The feed works offline; only Mann Darpan and sync need the network.

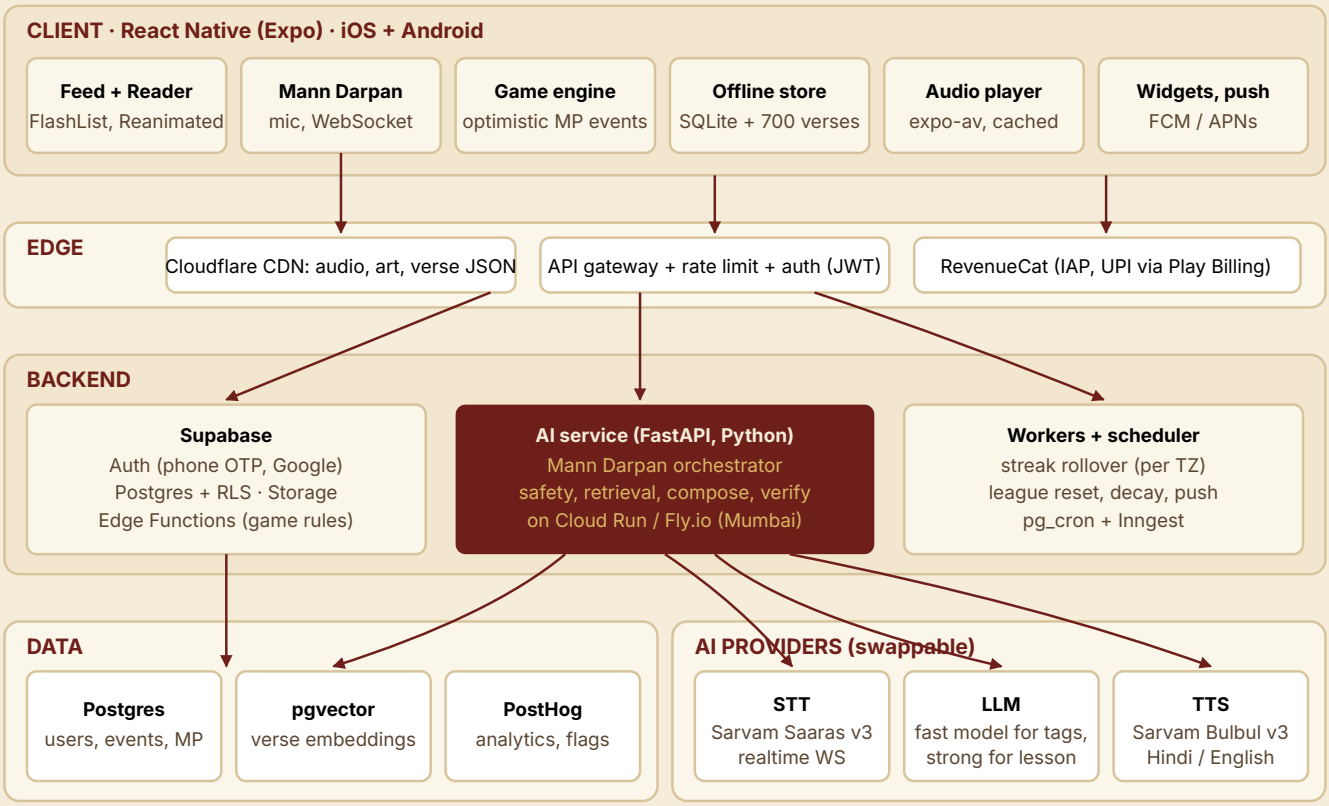


Figure 5. High-level architecture. Verse content ships inside the app and on the CDN, so the feed costs almost nothing per user.

Design principles

- **Offline-first feed:** all 700 verses + text (~3 MB) bundled; audio streamed and cached.
- **Server-authoritative points:** client shows optimistic MP, server validates events and applies caps and anti-gaming rules.
- **Provider-agnostic AI:** STT, LLM and TTS behind one interface, so we can swap for price or quality.
- **India region:** Mumbai hosting for latency and data residency.

Why React Native + Supabase

- One codebase, both stores, OTA updates via Expo for fast iteration.
- Supabase gives auth, Postgres, row-level security, storage and edge functions with no ops team.
- Flutter is equally valid; pick whichever the first engineers know. Do not go native-only at MVP.

13 · TECH STACK

Stack choices and the voice sequence

Layer	Choice	Why / alternative
Mobile	React Native + Expo, TypeScript	Fast, OTA updates. Alt: Flutter
UI / animation	Reanimated 3, FlashList, Skia for share cards	60 fps swipe feed, on-device card rendering
Local data	expo-sqlite (verses), MMKV (state)	Instant feed, works on flights and bad networks
Auth	Supabase Auth: phone OTP (MSG91 / Twilio), Google, Apple	Phone OTP is the Indian default
Database	Supabase Postgres + pgvector + RLS	One DB for app data and verse embeddings
AI service	Python FastAPI, Pydantic, async; deployed on Cloud Run / Fly.io Mumbai	Keeps prompts, safety and retrieval in one testable place
STT	Sarvam Saaras v3 (realtime WebSocket); fallback Deepgram / Whisper	Built for Indian languages and code-mixed Hinglish; ~₹30 per audio hour
LLM	Small fast model for tagging and safety; stronger model for the lesson; Sarvam-105B as Indic option	Route by task to keep cost per session under ₹3
TTS	Sarvam Bulbul v3; chants are pre-recorded, never synthesised	Natural Hindi voice; ~₹30 per 10K characters
Embeddings	Multilingual embedding model (e.g. bge-m3 self-hosted or a hosted API)	Must handle Hindi, English and Hinglish queries
Payments	RevenueCat over Google Play Billing (UPI Autopay) and App Store	One entitlement system across stores
Push / jobs	FCM + APNs via Expo Notifications; pg_cron + Inngest	Timezone-aware streak rollover, league resets
Analytics	PostHog (events, funnels, flags, A/B), Sentry (crashes)	Self-hostable later for privacy
CMS	Directus or Sanity on top of the verse tables	Scholars edit lessons and tags without engineers

Mann Darpan sequence

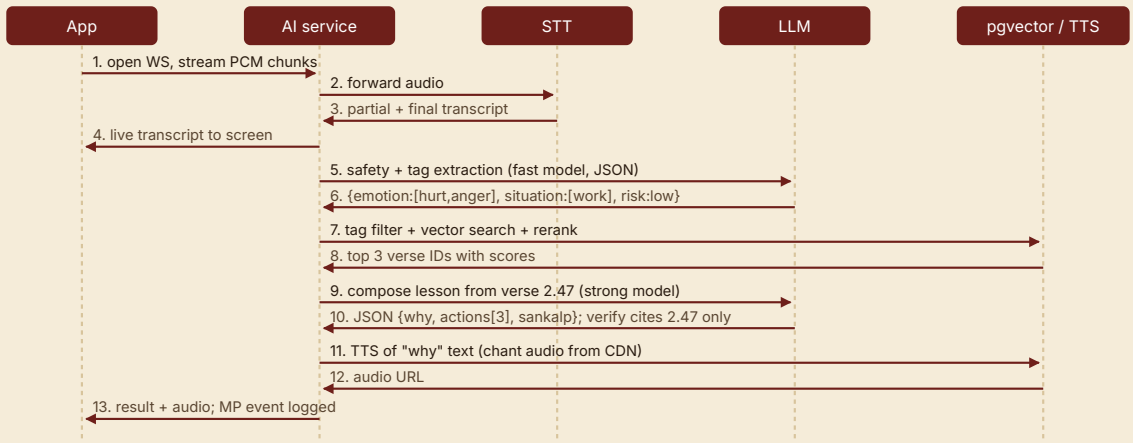


Figure 6. Steps 5 and 7 run in parallel with transcription finalisation where possible to stay under 4 seconds.

14 · DATA MODEL

Core tables

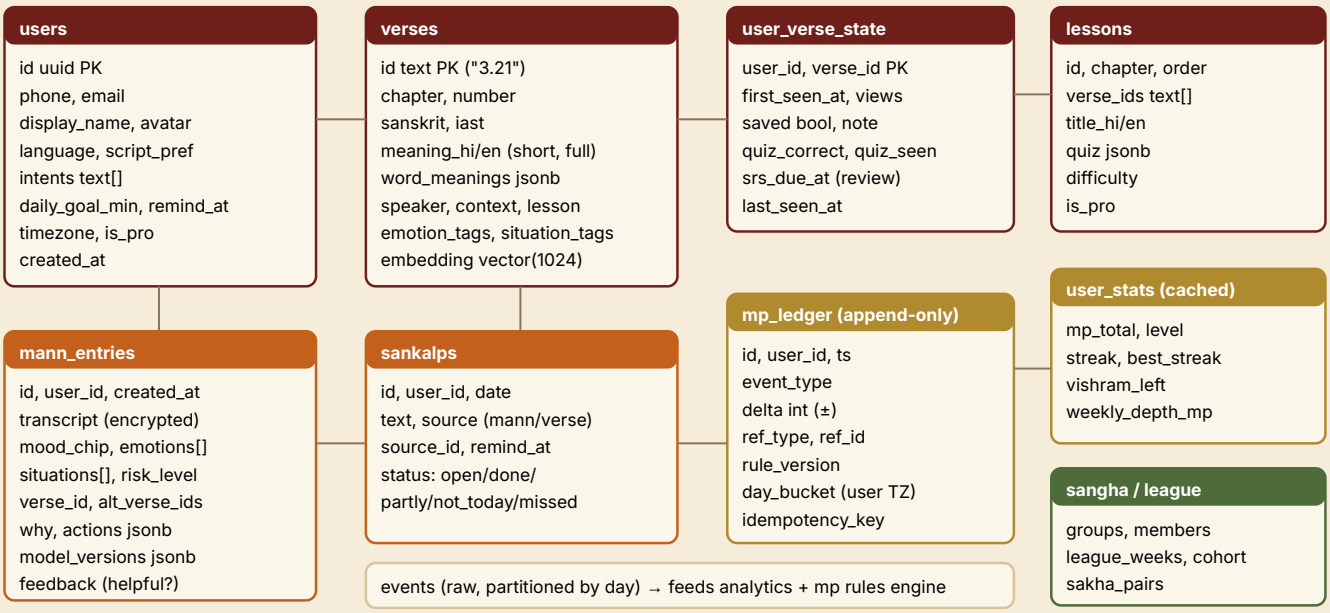


Figure 7. Entity sketch. The append-only MP ledger makes every point auditable and lets you change rules with a version number.

Key API endpoints

Endpoint	Purpose
`GET /feed?mode=foryou&cursor=`	Next 20 verse IDs (blend of sequential, mood-matched, popular, due-for-review); content itself is local
`POST /events (batch)`	verse_view, expand_open, checkpoint_answer, share… Server validates, applies caps, writes mp_ledger
`WS /mann/stream`	Audio in, partial transcript and final result out
`POST /mann/text`	Typed fallback for Mann Darpan
`POST /sankalp · PATCH /sankalp/:id`	Create commitment; evening check-in status
`GET /yatra · POST /lesson/:id/complete`	Path state; lesson completion with quiz answers
`GET /me/stats · GET /me/ledger`	Level, streak, Vishram, transparent MP history
`GET /sangha/league · POST /sangha/nudge`	Weekly league standings; nudge a Sakha
`DELETE /me`	Full data deletion (DPDP Act compliance)

14 · AI PIPELINE DETAIL

Making the shloka match feel magical

Quality of the match is the product. It comes far more from the tagged verse index than from the model.

Step A: build the Verse Situation Index (offline, once)

1. Define a taxonomy of ~40 emotions (grief, anger, envy, fear of failure, pride, joy...) and ~60 situations (exam, breakup, job loss, family conflict, illness of parent, success, comparison...).
2. For each of 700 verses, a Sanskrit scholar plus a writer assign tags with weights and write 3 to 5 "situations" sentences in plain Hinglish: "When you worked hard and someone dismissed it."
3. Flag verses that should **never** be served for personal advice out of context (war and killing passages in Ch 1 and 2, varna passages, verses easily misread). These stay readable in the feed with context, but are excluded from Mann Darpan retrieval.
4. Embed the situation sentences, not the Sanskrit, with a multilingual model; store in pgvector.
5. Build a gold set of 500 real-style user entries with the scholar's ideal verse, to evaluate every change.

Step B: retrieval at runtime

- Hybrid score = 0.5 × tag overlap + 0.4 × vector similarity + 0.1 × freshness (not shown to this user recently)
- Rerank top 10 with a small cross-encoder or LLM judge, return top 3
- Target: top-1 match accepted by scholar ≥ 80%, top-3 ≥ 95% on the gold set

Step C: composition prompt (sketch)

```
You are Sakha, a calm companion who explains the
Bhagavad Gita. You are NOT Krishna. Never speak as
God.

USER_LANGUAGE: hinglish
USER_SUMMARY: {summary}
EMOTIONS: {emotions}  SITUATION: {situations}
VERSE: {id} | {sanskrit} | {meaning} | {context}
SCHOLAR_LESSON: {lesson}

Write JSON:
 why: 2 sentences linking the user's words to
      THIS verse only. Quote no other verse.
 actions: 3 concrete steps for next 24h, kind,
      specific, no medical/legal/financial advice.
 sankalp: one short first-person commitment.
Rules: no politics, caste, other religions, no
violence, no fear or guilt, no promises of
outcomes. If unsure, stay general and gentle.
```

Step D: verification

- Schema check; regex and classifier for other verse references, banned topics, imperative harm
- On failure: retry once, then fall back to the scholar's pre-written lesson for that verse
- Log model versions for every entry; weekly human review of a random 2% sample

Cost per Mann Darpan session (estimate)

Component	Assumption	Cost
STT (Sarvam)	60 s audio at ₹30 per hour	₹0.50
Tagging + safety (fast LLM)	~800 in / 150 out tokens	₹0.05 to 0.15
Lesson (strong LLM)	~1,800 in / 350 out tokens	₹0.50 to 1.20
Embedding + rerank	1 query + 10 pairs	₹0.05
TTS (Bulbul v3)	~500 characters at ₹30 per 10K chars	₹1.50
Total	Make TTS optional (text-first) to halve cost	**₹2.6 to 3.4**

At 3 free sessions a week, a free user costs about ₹40/month in AI at worst. This is why Mann Darpan, not the feed, is the paywall lever. Verify current provider prices before launch; they change often.

15 · CONTENT, LICENSING AND AI SAFETY

Get the content and trust right

Licensing: the trap most Gita apps fall into

Content	Status	What to do
Sanskrit verses	Public domain	Use freely. Cross-check text against a standard critical edition.
Modern translations and commentaries (ISKCON/BBT, Chinmaya, Divine Life Society, Gita Press, etc.)	Copyrighted	Do not copy. Many open datasets on GitHub bundle these; using them commercially is a legal risk. License formally or write your own.
bhagavadgita.io API	Non-commercial	Its terms allow free API use only for non-commercial apps with attribution. Fine for prototyping, not for a paid product.
Open SDKs (OpenGita, vedicscriptures data)	Mixed	Code may be MIT, but the bundled translations keep their own rights. Check each translator.
Own translations, lessons, tags	Your IP	Commission 1 to 2 Sanskrit scholars (₹2 to 4 lakh for all 700 verses, Hindi + English short meanings and lessons). This is also your moat.
Chant audio, illustrations	Commission	Work-for-hire contracts with full rights transfer.

Neutrality and sampradaya

The Gita is read differently by Advaita, Vishishtadvaita, Dvaita, Gaudiya and other traditions. DharmaScroll should present a **plain, non-sectarian meaning** by default, cite which tradition a deeper interpretation comes from, and later offer optional "commentary lenses" (Shankara, Ramanuja, modern). This avoids alienating any group and avoids looking like one organisation's app.

AI safety framework

Hard rules

- Never impersonate Krishna or any deity; never claim divine authority.
- Never generate scripture; only quote from our database.
- No content endorsing violence, self-harm, caste hierarchy, gender roles, or political positions.
- No medical, legal or financial advice; redirect gently.
- Self-harm or abuse signals: immediate warm handoff to Tele-MANAS 14416 and 112, no lesson, no points.
- No claims that the user will be rewarded, cured or punished.

Process

- Red-team suite of 300+ adversarial prompts (the Rest of World questions on killing, caste and politics included), run in CI on every prompt or model change.
- Advisory panel: one Sanskrit scholar, one clinical psychologist, one representative from a different tradition.
- "Was this helpful / something wrong?" on every result; flags reviewed within 48 h.
- Publish a short public "How DharmaScroll uses AI" page.
- DPDP Act 2023: explicit consent, purpose limitation, data deletion, grievance officer.
- Age gate 13+; under-18 users get stricter content and no leagues with strangers.

16 · MONETIZATION AND UNIT ECONOMICS

Free to scroll, pay to go deeper

Reading the Gita stays free forever. That is both the right thing in this category and the growth engine. Money comes from what costs us money (AI voice) and what serious users value (depth, audio, family).

Free

- Full feed, all 700 shlokas, all languages
- Expand sheet, checkpoints, share cards
- Yatra chapters 1 to 6
- Mann Darpan 3 times a week (text answer, voice for first 3)
- Points, levels, leagues, 2 Vishram days

Pro · ₹99/mo · ₹699/yr

- Unlimited Mann Darpan with voice
- All 18 Yatra chapters + seasonal Yatras
- Ask about any shloka
- Audio Satsang library
- All illustrated decks, offline audio
- Unlimited Tapasya Shield

Parivar · ₹999/yr

- Pro for up to 5 family members
- Private family Sangha with shared streak
- Kids mode (later)

Diaspora pricing: $4.99/mo or $34.99/yr via store regional pricing. Sri Mandir's diaspora ARPU is ~10x India's.

Pricing logic

Hallow charges $69.99/year and Scroll the Bible $39.99/year in the US. GitaGPT-style Indian apps sit near ₹199/month. ₹699/year (≈ ₹58/month) is priced below a single movie ticket a month, which is the right mental anchor for Indian 18 to 35 year olds, while diaspora pays western prices. Offer a 7-day trial on yearly only, with UPI Autopay and a reminder before the trial ends (avoids bad reviews).

Revenue projection (illustrative, conservative)

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Cumulative installs	3 lakh	20 lakh	60 lakh
MAU (end of year)	60K	4 lakh	20 lakh
Paying subscribers (India, 2 to 2.5% of MAU)	1,200	8,000	48,000
Paying subscribers (diaspora)	200	2,000	12,000
Net revenue per India sub / yr (after store fee)	₹600	₹650	₹650
Net revenue per diaspora sub / yr	₹2,800	₹3,000	₹3,000
Subscription revenue	**~₹13 L**	**~₹1.1 Cr**	**~₹6.7 Cr**
AI + infra cost (est.)	₹6 L	₹35 L	₹1.4 Cr

Assumptions are deliberately conservative and should be replaced with real funnel data after beta. Upside levers are not included.

Later revenue streams (after product-market fit)

- **B2B:** schools (value education), corporate wellness ("Gita for leaders" programs)
- **Courses:** paid cohort-based deep dives with scholars
- **Physical:** printed Gita, illustrated card decks, Sthitaprajna certificate kits
- **Partnerships:** affiliate with puja platforms (do not build commerce yourself early)
- **Sponsorship:** festival Yatras sponsored by aligned brands, never in-feed ads
- **Never:** ads inside the feed or selling journal data

17 · GO-TO-MARKET

Launch on a festival, grow on reels

Faith apps grow in calendar spikes. Hallow's Lent challenge drives its year. India has a far richer calendar. The playbook: build the waitlist on Instagram and YouTube Shorts, launch with an 18-day Yatra on a festival, and let share cards do the rest.

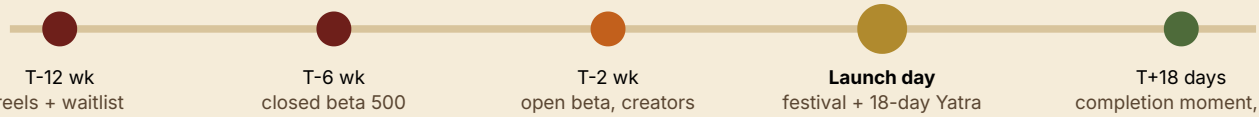
The 18-day Gita Yatra (signature campaign)

One chapter a day for 18 days, mirroring the 18 days of Kurukshetra. Each day: a 5-minute lesson, a Mann Darpan prompt themed to the chapter, and a share card. Completion badge "Kurukshetra 18" and a certificate. Run it 3 to 4 times a year: **Gita Jayanti** (Margashirsha Shukla Ekadashi, around December), **New Year**, **Chaitra Navratri**, and before **board exams** (Feb) as "Exam Yatra" for students.

Channel plan

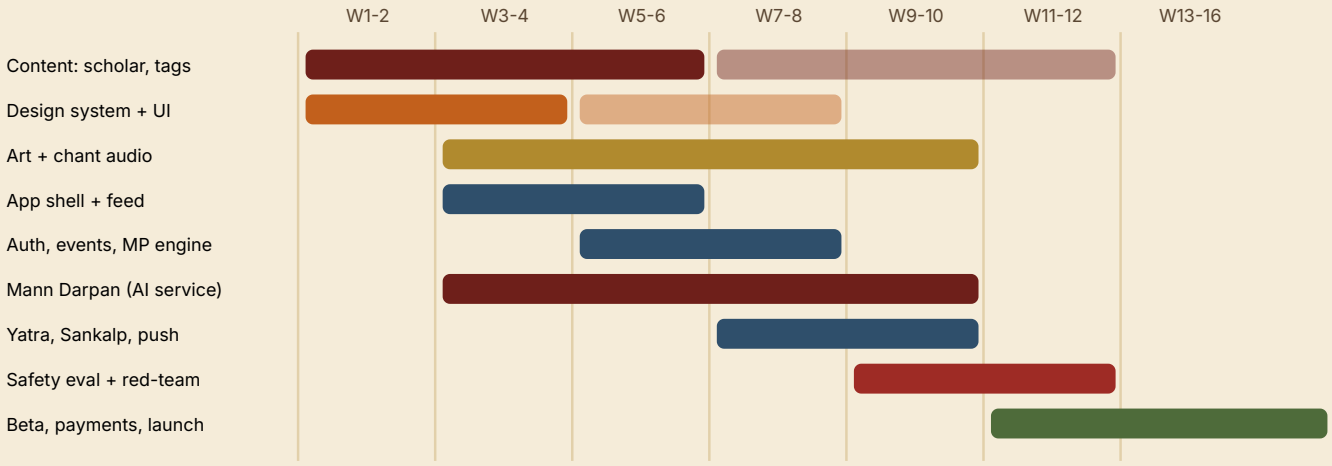
Channel	Tactic	Cost
Instagram / YT Shorts	Daily reels in the app's parchment style: "Gita for your Monday", "What Krishna would say about your boss". Every reel ends with the app. 3 months pre-launch to build a waitlist of 20K+.	Low (in-house)
Creator partnerships	30 to 50 micro-creators in spirituality, self-help, student and Hindi motivation niches; affiliate code gives a month of Pro.	₹3 to 6 L launch
WhatsApp	Daily Shloka channel; share cards designed for Status; family Sangha invites spread via family groups.	Free
Campus ambassadors	College spiritual and cultural clubs; "Exam Yatra" challenge across colleges with leaderboards.	Swag + Pro
ASO	Target "Bhagavad Gita", "Gita in Hindi", "shloka", "Krishna quotes", "daily motivation Hindi"; screenshots show the parchment feed and Mann Darpan.	Free
Paid	Only after D7 retention ≥ 20%: Meta + Google UAC in Hindi belt, plus diaspora geos (US, UK, UAE, Canada, Australia) around festivals.	Test ₹2 L, scale on CAC
Institutions	Free Parivar plans for temples, ashrams and Gita study circles in exchange for promotion.	Low
PR	Story angle: "Indian student builds the anti-doomscroll Gita app"; responsible AI angle contrasts with 2023 GitaGPT coverage.	Free

Launch sequence



18 · IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

From zero to launch in 16 weeks



Phase	Scope	Exit criteria
0. Foundations W1 to 2	Taxonomy, scholar onboarding, brand, design system, 10 key screens in Figma, tech spike on Sarvam realtime STT latency	Taxonomy signed off; STT p95 < 1.5 s
1. Build MVP W3 to 10	Feed (offline), expand sheet, checkpoints, share cards, Library, phone OTP, MP ledger and rules, streaks, Vishram, Mann Darpan v1 (Ch 2, 3, 6, 12 tagged first, ~200 verses), Sankalp, Yatra Ch 1 to 3, notifications, widget	Internal dogfood 2 weeks; gold-set top-1 ≥ 75%
2. Beta W11 to 14	500 closed beta (waitlist + campus), red-team suite, all 700 verses tagged, payments via RevenueCat, analytics funnels	D7 ≥ 20%; zero safety incidents in review
3. Launch W15 to 16	Store listing, ASO, creator wave, 18-day Yatra live	Store rating ≥ 4.5
V1.1 · M5 to 6	Sangha leagues, family groups, Sakha, Audio Satsang, Marathi + Bengali	DAU/MAU ≥ 25%
V1.2 · M7 to 9	Focus lock, commentary lenses, Tamil/Telugu/Gujarati, Ramayana highlights	Pro conversion ≥ 2%
V2 · M10 to 12	Upanishads, Vidura Niti, Kids mode, B2B schools pilot, web app	Break-even path visible

Team for MVP

Role	Type
Founder: product + AI service	Full-time
Mobile engineer (React Native) ×1 to 2	Full-time
Product designer	Contract, 10 wk
Sanskrit scholar + content writer	Contract
Illustrator, chant artist, voice artist	Contract
Social media / community lead	Part-time from W1

MVP budget (lean, INR)

Item	Estimate
Engineering (2 devs, 4 months)	₹6 to 10 L
Design	₹1.5 to 2.5 L
Scholar, writing, tagging	₹2 to 4 L
Illustrations (60 scenes)	₹1.5 to 3 L
Chant + meaning audio (700 × 2)	₹1.5 to 3 L
Infra + AI (beta)	₹0.5 L
Launch marketing	₹3 to 6 L
Total	**₹16 to 29 L**

19 · KPIS, RISKS AND MITIGATIONS

How we know it is working

40%	20%	25%+	80%
Day-1 retention target	Day-7 retention target (gate for paid UA)	DAU / MAU (habit strength)	Mann Darpan rated "helpful"

Area	Metric	Target (6 months)
Activation	% new users reading 5 shlokas on day 0; % completing sign-up	70% / 45%
Aha moment	% of activated users who try Mann Darpan in first 3 days	35%
Depth	Share of MP from depth actions vs reading (proves it is not a mindless scroll)	≥ 55% depth
Commitment	Sankalp check-in rate (done or partly)	50%
Learning	Users who complete Chapter 3; average shlokas per user per week	15% / 40
Virality	Share cards per WAU; K-factor	0.3 / 0.25
Monetization	Trial start rate; trial to paid; free to paid	6% / 35% / 2%
Trust and safety	Flagged answers per 1,000; crisis handoffs reviewed	< 2 / 100%
Wellbeing (north star guard)	Average daily time in app; self-reported "calmer" in monthly pulse	10 to 20 min / ≥ 60%

North star: **weekly users who kept at least one Sankalp**. It captures reading, reflection and action, and cannot be inflated by mindless scrolling.

Risk register

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
AI says something offensive or harmful about religion, caste, violence	High	Retrieval-only verses, excluded-verse list, persona that never speaks as God, red-team in CI, human review, fast takedown
Fast copycats (Scroll the Bible style apps were cloned in weeks)	High	Own translations and Verse Situation Index, Hinglish voice quality, community and leagues, festival brand moments
Gamification feels disrespectful or punitive	Med	Spiritual naming, no deductions for mood, honest check-ins rewarded, Vishram days, user research with devout users before launch
Copyright claim on translations	Med	Own or licensed translations only; legal review of every dataset
Low willingness to pay in India	Med	Diaspora pricing, Parivar plan, keep costs tiny (offline feed), B2B later
AI cost blows up with scale	Med	Free limits, text-first answers, caching of verse lessons, model routing, Indic providers in INR
Becomes another addictive scroll	Med	Daily point caps, checkpoints, speed-scroll pause, "you're done for today" moment, wellbeing metric as guardrail
Sectarian backlash	Low	Neutral default meanings, advisory panel across traditions, optional commentary lenses
Privacy breach of journal data	High	Encrypt transcripts, delete audio, RLS, minimal retention, DPDP compliance, security audit pre-launch

20 · SOURCES

Research sources

Market and competitor figures were gathered in November 2026 from the sources below. Third-party estimates (Appfigures, Tracxn, industry reports) are estimates, not audited figures. Verify pricing for AI providers and app stores before committing budgets.

Topic	Source
Scroll the Bible: features, pricing	apps.apple.com/app/id6756558351
Scroll the Bible: rating, OpenAI use, feature review	learnofchrist.com/resources/scroll-the-bible
Vessel: Body · Mind · Spirit	appgoblin.info/apps/6786153647
Sown: Scroll the Bible & Swipe	play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.janus.scroll
HolyReel, BibleTok, ChristPath, Bible Scroll, BibleScroll Screen Time	Apple App Store listings (ids 6753950682, 6757410433, 6785938529, 6755852591); mwm.ai/apps/biblescroll-screen-time-faith
Hallow revenue, Pray40, Lent downloads	appfigures.com/resources/insights/hallow-lent-surge-prayer-app-revenue
Hallow pricing	appstorespy.com (Hallow listing)
Sri Mandir MAU, ARPU, run rate, market growth, funding trends	techcrunch.com/2025/06/30/sri-mandir-keeps-investors-hooked-as-digital-devotion-grows
Sri Mandir FY25 revenue and loss	inc42.com (AppsForBharat FY25 results)
Sri Mandir commission model, MAU, temples	inc42.com/startups/can-appsforbharat-build-the-uber-or-airbnb-for-indias-spiritual-tech-market
AppsForBharat funding, downloads	entrepreneur.com (Series C); clay.com/dossier/appsforbharat-funding
Indian faith market size and drivers	inc42.com/features/decoding-the-cosmic-rise-of-indian-spiritual-tech-startups
Religion-tech startup count, Astrotalk model	outlookbusiness.com (India's love for religion, astrology births $35 billion industry)
GitaGPT chatbots and violence findings	Rest of World via CBC (cbc.ca/amp/1.6896628), The Quint explainer, pressreader reprint
GitaGPT pricing	aichief.com/ai-religion-tools/gitagpt
Duolingo DAU and retention 2026	pulse2.com (Q2 2026 DAU); pocketgamer.biz (365-day streaks)
Duolingo streak experiments	blog.duolingo.com/improving-the-streak; Duolingo retention team talk
Sarvam AI STT and TTS pricing, realtime API	dqindia.com (Sarvam audio model); docs.sarvam.ai/changelog; usagepricing.com/blueprint/sarvam-ai
Gita data licensing	bhagavadgita.io/copyright; github.com/vedicscriptures/bhagavad-gita-data; pypi.org/project/opengita

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उद्धरेदात्मनात्मानं नात्मानमवसादयेत्।

Lift yourself by your own self; do not let yourself sink. (Gita 6.5)